Comments & Activity History – Technical Documentation

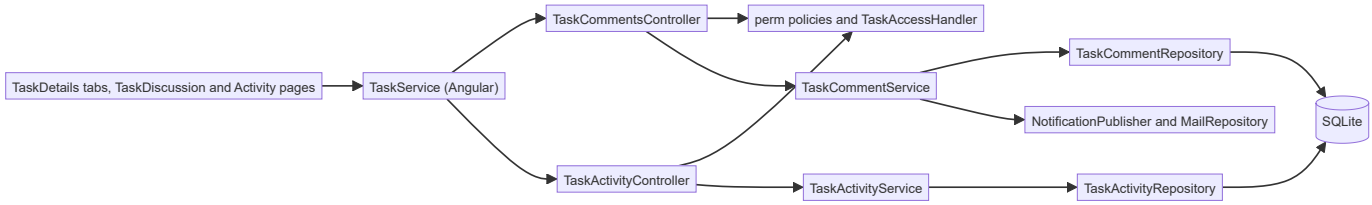
> **Project:** TaskFlow – Intelligent Task Allocation & Tracking System **Parent Module:** Monitoring · **Child Module:** 04.2 Comments & Activity History **Version:** 1.0 · **Last Updated:** 31-Oct-2026 **Backend:** ASP.NET Core Web API (.NET 10) · **Frontend:** Angular · **Database:** SQLite (EF Core) **Author:** Jojo George (jojogeorge3344@gmail.com) © 2026 Jojo George. All rights reserved.

1. Technical Overview

This child is served by two controllers under `[Route("api/v1/tasks")]` with class-level `[Authorize]`: `TaskCommentsController` (4 comment endpoints) and `TaskActivityController` (activity history plus 2 Administrator hours-correction endpoints), 7 endpoints in total.

- `TaskCommentService` adds, edits and soft-deletes comments, enforces the author rule, appends history entries and notifies the task's members (in-app and system mail).
- `TaskActivityService` is the single writer of the append-only history (`AppendAsync`, called by every task and comment action), reads it with filters, and implements the Administrator's worked-hours corrections, which replay the running totals.
- Endpoints are guarded by `perm:<key>` policies and the `TaskAccess` resource policy (`TaskAccessHandler`). The hours-correction endpoints use an inline `role == "Administrator"` check.
- Frontend: the Discussion and Activity history summary tabs in `TaskDetailsComponent`, plus the full pages `TaskDiscussionComponent` and `ActivityComponent`, which are referenced by the routes but not in the snapshot.

2. Architecture Flow



3. Backend File Structure

Layer	Path	Files
Controller	`TaskFlow.Api/Controllers/Monitoring/`	`TaskCommentsController.cs`, `TaskActivityController.cs`
Service	`TaskFlow.Api/Services/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Discussion/`	`ITaskCommentService.cs`, `TaskCommentService.cs`
Service	`TaskFlow.Api/Services/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Activity/`	`ITaskActivityService.cs`, `TaskActivityService.cs`
Repository	`TaskFlow.Api/Repositories/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Discussion/`	`ITaskCommentRepository.cs`, `TaskCommentRepository.cs`

Layer	Path	Files
Repository	`TaskFlow.Api/Repositories/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Activity/`	`ITaskActivityRepository.cs`, `TaskActivityRepository.cs`
DTOs	`TaskFlow.Api/Dtos/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Discussion/`	`TaskCommentDtos.cs` (`TaskCommentDto`, `AddCommentRequest`)
DTOs	`TaskFlow.Api/Dtos/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Activity/`	`TaskActivityDtos.cs` (`ActivityEntryDto`, `UpdateHoursEntryRequest`), `ActivityFilter.cs`
Validators	`TaskFlow.Api/Dtos/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Discussion/Validators/`	`AddCommentRequestValidator.cs`
Entities	`TaskFlow.Api/Models/Entities/`	`TaskComment.cs`, `TaskActivityLog.cs`
Enums	`TaskFlow.Api/Models/Enums/`	`TaskActivityEventType.cs`, `NotificationType.cs`
Authorization (shared)	`TaskFlow.Api/Authorization/TaskAccess/`	`TaskAccessRequirement.cs`, `TaskAccessHandler.cs` (uses `Services/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Access/TaskAccessService.cs`)

4. Frontend File Structure

Type	Path	Purpose
Page component (summary tabs)	`src/app/modules/monitoring/task-management/pages/task-details.component.*`	Discussion tab (latest 3 comments, `getComments`) and Activity history tab (latest 4 entries, `getActivity`)
Page component (missing)	`src/app/modules/monitoring/task-management/discussion/pages/task-discussion.component`	Full discussion page – referenced by the routes, not in the snapshot
Page component (missing)	`src/app/modules/monitoring/task-management/activity/pages/activity.component`, `.../activity/utils/activity-meta`	Full activity page and event metadata (`ActivityEventMeta`, `eventMeta`, imported by `task-details.component.ts`) – not in the snapshot
API service	`src/app/modules/monitoring/task-management/services/task.service.ts`	`getComments`, `addComment`, `updateComment`, `deleteComment`, `getActivity`, `updateHoursEntry`, `deleteHoursEntry`
Models	`src/app/modules/monitoring/task-management/models/task.model.ts`	`TaskComment`, `ActivityEntry`, `AddCommentRequest`
Models	`src/app/modules/monitoring/task-management/services/task.model.ts`	`ActivityFilter` (`eventType`, `actorUserId`, `from`, `to`, `search`)
Route / Guard	`src/app/modules/monitoring/monitoring.routes.ts` + `permissionGuard`	See the table below

Route	Guard permission
`/tasks/:id/discussion`	none (signed-in only)
`/tasks/:id/activity`	`tasks.activity.view`

5. API & Logic

5.1 API Endpoints

#	Method	Endpoint	Description	Permission (Policy)	Request DTO	Response DTO
1	GET	`/api/v1/tasks/{id:int}/comments`	Comments, oldest first	`[Authorize]` + `TaskAccess`	–	`IReadOnlyCollection<TaskCommentDto>`
2	POST	`/api/v1/tasks/{id:int}/comments`	Add comment	`perm:tasks.comment.create` + `TaskAccess`	`AddCommentRequest`	`200 OK` + `TaskCommentDto`
3	PUT	`/api/v1/tasks/{id:int}/comments/{commentId:int}`	Edit own comment	`perm:tasks.comment.edit` + `TaskAccess` + author check	`AddCommentRequest`	`TaskCommentDto`
4	DELETE	`/api/v1/tasks/{id:int}/comments/{commentId:int}`	Soft-delete own comment	`perm:tasks.comment.delete` + `TaskAccess` + author check	–	`204 No Content`
5	GET	`/api/v1/tasks/{id:int}/activity`	Activity history, filtered	`perm:tasks.activity.view` + `TaskAccess`	Query: `eventType`, `actorUserId`, `from`, `to`, `search`	`IReadOnlyCollection<ActivityEntryDto>`
6	PUT	`/api/v1/tasks/{id:int}/activity/{entryId:int}/hours`	Correct one worked-hours entry	`[Authorize]` + inline `role == "Administrator"`	`UpdateHoursEntryRequest`	`204 No Content`
7	DELETE	`/api/v1/tasks/{id:int}/activity/{entryId:int}/hours`	Remove one worked-hours entry	`[Authorize]` + inline `role == "Administrator"`	–	`204 No Content`

Controllers: rows 1–4 are in `TaskCommentsController`, and rows 5–7 are in `TaskActivityController` (both `[Route("api/v1/tasks")]`, `[Authorize]`).

For `GET /activity`, the controller converts `from` and `to` to UTC. A `to` value with no time of day is extended to the end of that day (`Date.AddDays(1).AddTicks(-1)`).

5.2 Request / Response Samples

```
// POST /api/v1/tasks/42/comments
{ "body": "Draft is ready for review." }
```

```
// 200 OK
{ "id": 310, "body": "Draft is ready for review.", "authorUserId": 12, "authorName": "Asha Nair",
  "createdAt": "2026-10-31T10:05:00Z", "editedAt": null }
```

```
// GET /api/v1/tasks/42/activity?eventType=HoursLogged  -> 200 OK
[ { "id": 901, "eventType": "HoursLogged", "actorUserId": 12, "actorName": "Asha Nair",
    "oldValue": "0", "newValue": "2.5", "message": "Worked hours logged: 2.5h (total)",
    "createdAt": "2026-10-31T11:00:00Z" } ]
```

```
// PUT /api/v1/tasks/42/activity/901/hours
{ "hours": 2 }
// 204 No Content
```

5.3 Service Layer Logic

`TaskCommentService` (`Services/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Discussion/TaskCommentService.cs`)

- `GetForTaskAsync(taskId)` returns the live comments, oldest first, with the author's name (soft-deleted authors are still shown).
- `AddAsync(taskId, AddCommentRequest request, authorUserId)`:
  1. A blank body → `BusinessRuleException("Comment must not be empty.")`.
  2. The task must be live (`ITaskRepository.GetLiveAsync`) → `"Task not found."` (400).
  3. Insert a `TaskComment` (body trimmed, `CreatedAt` = now) and save.
  4. Append `CommentAdded` "New comment added" (new value = an excerpt of up to 200 characters plus "…").
  5. `NotifyMembersAsync(..., "added", ...)`.
- `UpdateAsync(taskId, commentId, request, actorUserId)`:
  1. Same body and task checks.
  2. Load with `GetLiveForUpdateAsync`. Missing → `null` (404).
  3. A non-author → `ForbiddenException("Only the author can edit this comment.")`.
  4. Set Body and `EditedAt`, and save.
  5. Append `CommentEdited` "Comment edited" (old/new excerpts) and notify with "edited".
- `DeleteAsync(taskId, commentId, actorUserId)`:
  1. Task check, then the comment. Missing → `false` (404).
  2. A non-author → `"Only the author can delete this comment."`.
  3. Set `IsDeleted = true` and save.
  4. Append `CommentDeleted` "Comment deleted" (old value = excerpt) and notify with "deleted".
- `NotifyMembersAsync` (best effort; on failure it calls `_mail.DiscardStagedMail()` and logs a warning):
  1. Targets: recipient ids ∪ assignee ∪ actor, filtered to live users (`GetLiveIdsAsync`).
  2. Notification `TaskComment`: `{who} {verb} a comment on "{title}": {detail}`.
  3. If `SettingKeys.NotificationMailEnabled` is true, or missing or unreadable, it builds one system `MailMessage` (`IsSystem = true`, `TaskId` set, subject `Comment {verb}: {title}` cut to `MailRules.MaxSubjectLength`) with a `MailRecipient` (To) and an Inbox `MailboxItem` per target, and saves.

`TaskActivityService` (`Services/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Activity/TaskActivityService.cs`)

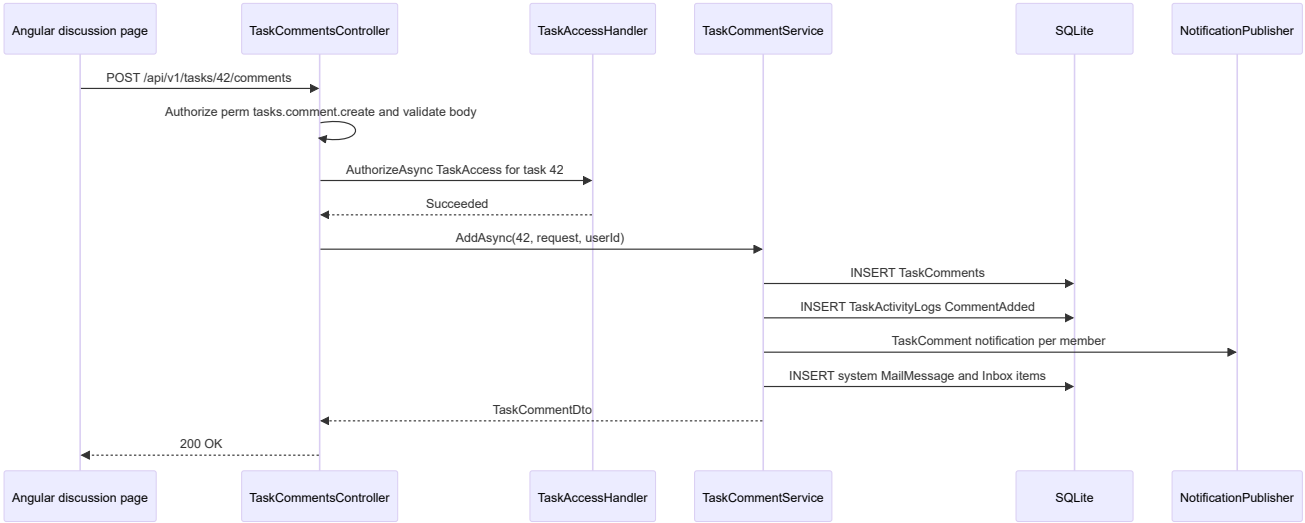
- `AppendAsync(taskId, eventType, actorUserId, message, oldValue, newValue)` adds a `TaskActivityLog` with `CreatedAt` = UTC now and calls `SaveChangesAsync`. The caller owns the transaction.
- `GetForTaskAsync(taskId, ActivityFilter)` maps the rows to `ActivityEntryDto`, with `EventType` as a string.

- `UpdateHoursEntryAsync(taskId, entryId, hours, actor)`: hours must be > 0 and ≤ 24, otherwise `"Hours must be greater than 0 and at most 24 per entry."`. Then it runs `ChangeHoursEntryAsync`.
- `DeleteHoursEntryAsync` runs `ChangeHoursEntryAsync` with no hours.
- `ChangeHoursEntryAsync`:
    1. Load the live task and all its `HoursLogged` entries (ordered by CreatedAt, then Id). A missing task or entry → `false` (404).
    2. Each entry's delta = NewValue − OldValue. Editing an entry whose delta ≤ 0 → `"This entry did not add hours, so it can only be deleted."`.
    3. Remove the target entry, or set its new delta.
    4. Replay all entries from the first entry's OldValue (baseline), clamping at 0, and rewrite OldValue, NewValue and Message ("Worked hours logged: Xh (total)").
    5. Set `Task.ActualHours` to the final total.
    6. Add an `Administrative` entry, "Administrator changed a worked-hours entry from Ah to Bh; worked total is now Ch" (or "Administrator deleted a worked-hours entry of Ah; …"), and save.

5.4 Repository Layer

Method	Description	Query Notes
`TaskCommentRepository.GetForTaskAsync(taskId)`	Live comments with author	`AsNoTracking`, `IgnoreQueryFilters`, `!IsDeleted`, ordered by CreatedAt then Id
`TaskCommentRepository.GetLiveForUpdateAsync(taskId, commentId)`	Tracked live comment of that task	Matches both Id and TaskId
`TaskActivityRepository.GetForTaskAsync(taskId, ActivityFilter)`	Filtered history	`AsNoTracking`; filters on EventType, ActorUserId, CreatedAt ≥ From, CreatedAt ≤ To, `Message.Contains(search)`; `IgnoreQueryFilters` + Include Actor; ordered by CreatedAt
`TaskActivityRepository.GetHoursEntriesForUpdateAsync(taskId)`	Tracked `HoursLogged` entries	Ordered by CreatedAt then Id

5.5 Sequence Diagram



6. Database Design

SQLite storage types come from the migrations: int and bool are stored as INTEGER, and string, DateTime and decimal as TEXT.

Table	Column	Type	Constraints	Description
`TaskComments`	`Id`	int	PK	–
`TaskComments`	`TaskId`	int	FK → Tasks.Id; index (`TaskId`, `CreatedAt`)	Task
`TaskComments`	`AuthorUserId`	int	FK → Users.Id	Author
`TaskComments`	`Body`	string	Not Null (validator max 4000)	Text
`TaskComments`	`CreatedAt`	datetime	Not Null	Posted time
`TaskComments`	`EditedAt`	datetime	Nullable	Last edit
`TaskComments`	`IsDeleted`	bool	Default false	Soft delete
`TaskActivityLogs`	`Id`	int	PK	–
`TaskActivityLogs`	`TaskId`	int	FK → Tasks.Id; index (`TaskId`, `CreatedAt`)	Task
`TaskActivityLogs`	`EventType`	enum `TaskActivityEventType`, stored as **string(32)**	Not Null	Created, Assigned, Reassigned, StatusChanged, DeadlineChanged, PriorityChanged, Completed, CommentAdded, Administrative, HoursLogged, TimeLogged, Deleted, CommentEdited, CommentDeleted
`TaskActivityLogs`	`ActorUserId`	int	FK → Users.Id	Who acted
`TaskActivityLogs`	`OldValue` / `NewValue`	string	Nullable	Before / after

Table	Column	Type	Constraints	Description
`TaskActivityLogs`	`Message`	string	Not Null	Human-readable text
`TaskActivityLogs`	`CreatedAt`	datetime	Not Null	When

Tables read or written but not owned: `Tasks` (live check, title, assignee; `ActualHours` rewritten by the hours correction), `TaskRecipients` (notification targets), `Users` (author and actor names, live check), and the Communication tables `MailMessages`, `MailRecipients` and `MailboxItems` (system comment mail, names from the `AppDbContext` `DbSet` properties) and `Notifications`.

Relationships

- `TaskComments.TaskId → Tasks.Id` (FK, Cascade); `TaskComments.AuthorUserId → Users.Id` (FK, Restrict)
- `TaskActivityLogs.TaskId → Tasks.Id` (FK, Cascade); `TaskActivityLogs.ActorUserId → Users.Id` (FK, Restrict)

7. Security & Authorization

- **Authorization:** `perm:<key>` policies on post, edit, delete and activity; the `TaskAccess` resource policy on every comment and activity read/write endpoint; the author check in `TaskCommentService`; an inline `role == "Administrator"` check in `TaskActivityController` for hours corrections.
- **Data scope:** `TaskAccessHandler` passes for view-all, assignee, creator or recipient. It does **not** apply the Manager team scope (see section 12).
- **Frontend:** `permissionGuard` on `/tasks/:id/activity`; the Activity history tab and the "View hours in activity history" link are gated by `canViewActivity`.

Permission Key	Endpoint(s)	UI Element Controlled
`tasks.comment.create`	`POST /tasks/{id}/comments`	Discussion page (component not in snapshot)
`tasks.comment.edit`	`PUT /tasks/{id}/comments/{commentId}`	Discussion page (component not in snapshot)
`tasks.comment.delete`	`DELETE /tasks/{id}/comments/{commentId}`	Discussion page (component not in snapshot)
`tasks.activity.view`	`GET /tasks/{id}/activity`	Activity history tab, "View hours in activity history" link, `/tasks/:id/activity` guard
(role Administrator)	`PUT` / `DELETE /tasks/{id}/activity/{entryId}/hours`	Activity page hours correction (component not in snapshot)

8. Validations & Error Handling

Rule	Layer	HTTP Code	Error Message
Comment empty / over 4000 characters	`AddCommentRequestValidator` / `TaskCommentService`	400	Comment must not be empty. (service)
Comment on a missing task	`TaskCommentService`	400	Task not found.
Hours outside 0–24 (correction)	`TaskActivityService`	400	Hours must be greater than 0 and at most 24 per entry.
Correcting a non-adding hours entry	`TaskActivityService`	400	This entry did not add hours, so it can only be deleted.
Not the comment author	`TaskCommentService`	403	Only the author can edit this comment. / Only the author can delete this comment.
Not Administrator (hours correction)	`TaskActivityController`	403	Forbidden (empty body)

Shared rows (policy 403, 404 not found, generic 409 and 500) and the error format are in the parent document, section 8.

9. Integrations / Side Effects

- **Notifications:** comment add, edit or delete → `TaskComment` to the assignee, recipients and actor (live users only), through `INotificationPublisher.PublishAsync` (skipped when in-app notifications are switched off).
- **Email / internal mail:** comments write a system `MailMessage` directly (`IMailRepository`) with Inbox items, subject "Comment {verb}: {title}". This is skipped when `SettingKeys.NotificationMailEnabled` is false. Best effort (logged, never rolled back).
- **Activity Log:** `TaskActivityService.AppendAsync` is the single writer for the whole module:

Action	Event type(s)
Create	`Created`, `Assigned`
Edit	`DeadlineChanged`, `PriorityChanged`, `HoursLogged`
Log hours	`HoursLogged`
Change status	`StatusChanged`, `Completed`
Reassign	`Reassigned`
Set recipients	`Assigned` ("Task recipients updated")
Delete	`Deleted`
Comments	`CommentAdded`, `CommentEdited`, `CommentDeleted`
Hours correction	`Administrative`

- **AI Assistant:** help topic `task-comments-and-activity.md` in `Services/Assistant/Knowledge/`.

10. Configuration

No `appsettings.json` keys are specific to this child. Setting stored in the database that it reads:

- Mail enabled (`SettingKeys.NotificationMailEnabled`) – controls the system comment mail.

The connection string, JWT lifetimes and the in-app notification switch are module-wide (parent document, section 10).

11. Testing

Paths are relative to `backend/tests` .

Test Type	File / Location	Covers
Unit	`TaskFlow.UnitTests/Monitoring/TaskManagement/Discussion/TaskCommentActivityNotificationTests.cs`	Comment activity and notifications

> ⚠️ To be confirmed: whether `TaskFlow.IntegrationTests/Monitoring/TaskManagement/TasksEndpointsTests.cs` (listed in 04.1) also covers the comment and activity endpoints. No dedicated test file for `TaskActivityService` or the hours correction is in the file list. Only the test file names are available.

12. Known Limitations / Gaps found

- Worked-hours corrections are limited to the role named "Administrator", not to a permission key, so a custom role cannot be given this ability.
- **Missing frontend files:** the routes `/tasks/:id/discussion` (`TaskDiscussionComponent`) and `/tasks/:id/activity` (`ActivityComponent`) and the util `../activity/utils/activity-meta` imported by `task-details.component.ts` are not in the snapshot. The UI for posting, editing and deleting comments, for activity filters and for the Administrator hours correction cannot be confirmed.
- **`TaskAccessHandler` lacks the manager team scope (audit B6, still valid).** Endpoints guarded only by `TaskAccess` are reachable by a Manager for any task id, including other teams':
  - `GET /comments` , `POST /comments` , `PUT /comments/{commentId}` , `DELETE /comments/{commentId}`
  - `GET /activity`

  `GET /tasks/{id}` , status, update, hours and reassign do apply the team check in `TaskService` (04.1).
- **BRD vs code:** Screen 18 lists "Task ID" and "Prevent ordinary users from modifying history". This is met, except for the Administrator hours correction, which is recorded as an `Administrative` entry.
- **Unreachable service message:** `TaskCommentService` 's "Comment must not be empty." is normally pre-empted by FluentValidation (`ValidationFilter`), so users see the validator's message instead.

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